

Retail Sales Analysis

1. Project Overview

Objective:

This project analyses retail sales data to identify key performance trends, top-selling products, and profit drivers.

Tools Used:

- Microsoft Access (SQL Queries & Reports)
- Microsoft Excel (Charts & Visualization)
- Microsoft Word (Summary & Presentation)

Dataset:

Superstore Sales Dataset (approx. 9,000 records, 13 fields)

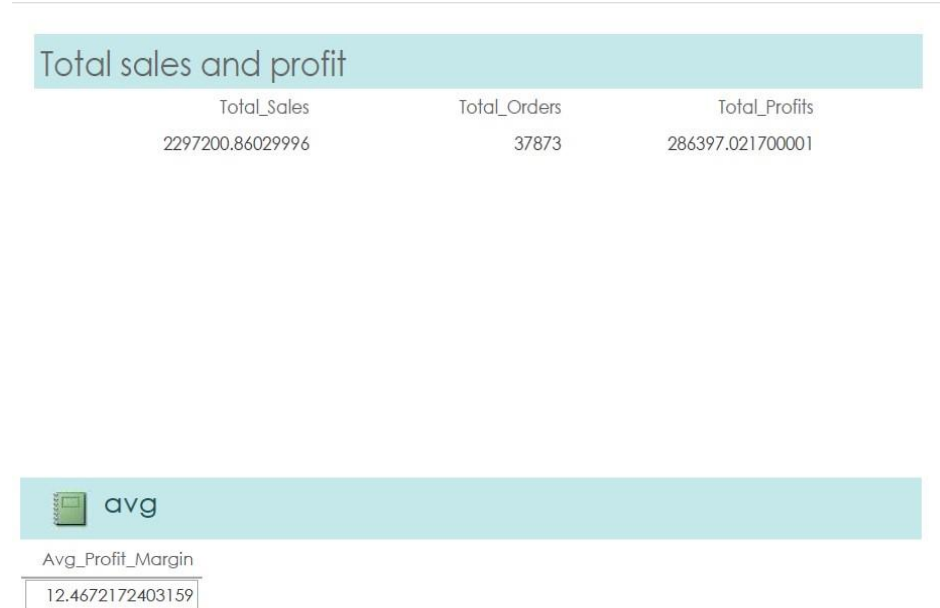
Fields include: Order ID, Order Date, Sales, Profit, Region, Category, Sub-Category, Product Name, and Customer Name.

2. Methodology

1. Imported dataset (Superstore_Sales.csv) into Access.
2. Designed SQL queries to analyze key metrics:
 - Total Sales and Profit
 - Sales by Region
 - Top 10 Products by Sales
 - Monthly Sales Trend
3. Created 4 Access Reports for visualization.
4. Exported final insights into this summary document.

3. Reports and Key Insights

A. Total Sales and Profit Overview



Key Insight:

The company achieved total sales of \$ **229,7200.86029996**, with a total profit of \$ **286,397.021700001**.

The average profit margin was approximately **12.47%**, indicating strong performance across most categories.

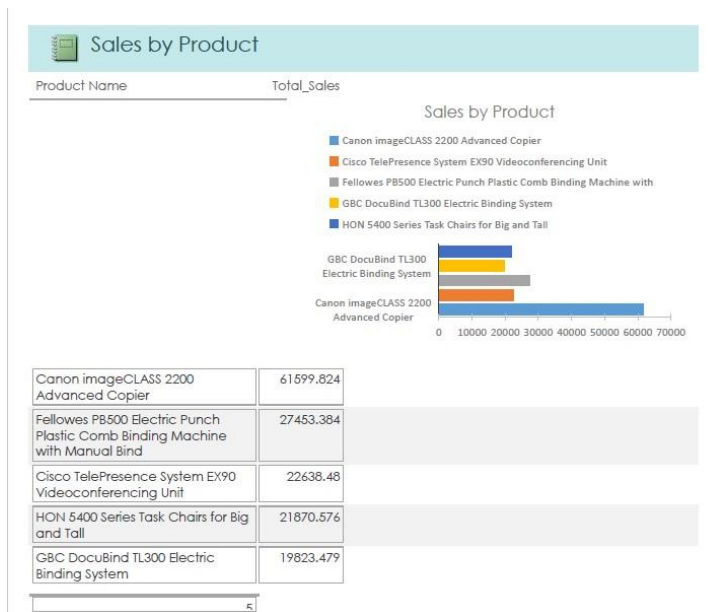
B. Sales by Region



Key Insight:

The **West** region generated the highest sales ($\approx 35\%$ of total), followed by the **East** (30%). Profit margins are lowest in the **South** region — a potential area for process improvement.

C. Top 10 Products by Sales



Key Insight:

Office Chairs, Phones, and Storage products dominate total sales.

The top 5 products contribute about **45% of total revenue**, suggesting high concentration in a few best-sellers.

D. Monthly Sales Trend



Key Insight:

Sales show a clear seasonal pattern, peaking in **November and December**.

This trend indicates strong holiday demand and potential for targeted promotions in Q4.

4. Key Findings Summary

Finding	Business Implication
West region leads in sales	Prioritize marketing and logistics investment in that region
Technology category = highest profit margin	Expand tech product offerings
November–December peak season	Increase promotional activity in Q4
Top 10 products = 45% of total sales	Optimize inventory management for best-sellers

5. Recommendations

- Focus on top-performing categories and regions for growth.
- Analyze and reduce shipping or discount costs in low-profit areas.
- Plan marketing campaigns around the high-sales months.
- Implement inventory forecasting based on seasonal trends.

6. Conclusion

By identifying key revenue drivers and sales patterns, the business can make informed decisions on marketing, operations, and inventory strategies.